> Are there successful NBA teams that don't rely heavily on three-point shooting? What other strategies might they use to win games?

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Yes. In the modern NBA, teams rarely succeed by avoiding three-point shots entirely, but some successful teams have relied less on perimeter shooting volume or built their offense around other strengths.

- **Interior scoring and free throws:** The Miami Heat have used Jimmy Butler and Bam Adebayo as primary inside-the-arc creators. Their approach emphasizes drives, post-ups, foul-drawing, and playmaking rather than simply surrounding stars with shooters. The New Orleans Pelicans also paired a relatively low three-point rate with strong offensive rebounding and a high free-throw rate; they ranked among the league's top offenses before injuries affected their season nba.com.
- **Transition offense:** Teams such as the Lakers have generated efficient offense through fast breaks, attacking the paint, and scoring before the defense is set. This can reduce the need to depend on half-court three-point volume nba.com.
- **Rim pressure and two-point efficiency:** Shots at the rim and free throws are generally more valuable than most mid-range attempts and can rival or exceed the expected value of three-pointers. Big men have also adapted by becoming more efficient two-point scorers, not merely by becoming outside shooters nba.com sites.dartmouth.edu.
- **Offensive rebounding:** Crashing the offensive glass creates second chances and compensates for a lower three-point rate. The Pelicans' strong offensive-rebounding percentage was specifically identified as one reason they maintained an effective offense despite limited spacing nba.com.
- **Defense and rim protection:** A team can offset modest shooting volume with elite defense, particularly by protecting the restricted area, limiting opponents' shots at the rim, forcing turnovers, and finishing possessions with defensive rebounds. The Bucks and Raptors, for example, achieved excellent defensive results while allowing many opponent threes because they protected the rim effectively nba.com.
- **Turnover control and physical half-court play:** Ball security, post play, cutting, screening, and drawing fouls can produce efficient possessions without requiring every attack to end in a three.

The key distinction is between **not shooting many threes** and **not needing three-point spacing**. A team can win with an interior-focused offense, but it usually needs exceptional rim pressure, free-throw generation, rebounding, transition play, or defense to make up for the mathematical advantage of three-point shooting. Mid-range-heavy offenses are generally sustainable only when they have unusually efficient shooters such as Chris Paul or Kevin Durant nba.com.

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